

Some programs such as SQL Server and Exchange Server set this value during installation and override the change.

Turn Off Windows Animation

Windows animations—like those that happen when you minimise or maximise windows—look good, but only if you have the processing power and/or RAM. To get the most performance out of your system turn off this setting. You could do it via a host of settings in the GUI, but this Registry hack does it all in one fell swoop.

Navigate to:

HCU\Control Panel\Desktop\WindowMetrics

Change the value called **MinAnimate** to **0** to disable Windows Animation. A restart is required.

Disable The Desktop Cleanup Wizard

By default the Desktop Cleanup Wizard runs every 60 days to clean up unused shortcuts and other desktop items. Do you need this over-friendly tool? At any rate, you don't want it to run automatically—use this hack.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Desktop\CleanupWiz

Modify the DWORD Value called **NoRun** to **0**, or to **1** to bring back the poor Wizard if you begin to pity it.

Control Master File Table Zone Reservation

On NTFS-enabled XP systems, you can control the amount of space allocated to the MFT. The MFT contains reference entries to all the files on the system. This can get fragmented over time and affect system performance. Use this hack to allocate sufficient space for the MFT.